Progressive Discipline Policy

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Policy type: Company-wide
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Owning Department: Human Resources (People & Culture)
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System of record: Confluence, Policies space, and ZenPeople (acknowledgement)
Related policies: ZEN-POL-001 (Code of Conduct and Business Ethics Policy); ZEN-POL-002 (Hybrid Work Policy); ZEN-POL-005 (Acceptable Use and Electronic Communication Policy); ZEN-POL-006 (Information Security Policy); ZEN-POL-008 (Prevention of Sexual Harassment (POSH) Policy); ZEN-DPL-HR-01 (Performance Management and Appraisal Policy)

Policy History

Revision	Amendment description	Effective date	Reviewed by	Approved by
1	First discipline procedure	1 Apr 2017	Head of People & Culture	Founder & CEO
2.0	Added PIP timeline and appeal route	1 Apr 2022	Head of People & Culture	Founder & CEO
2.1	Added links to POSH and Information Security policies	1 Jan 2024	Head of People & Culture	Founder & CEO

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1. Objective

To provide a fair, structured process for correcting conduct, performance and attendance issues, consistent with Zenvora's values and employment law.

2. Applies to

All employees (all bands), consultants and contractors working for Zenvora.

3. Principles

Discipline is meant to correct behaviour, not to punish. Zenvora may combine or skip steps depending on the facts and the seriousness of the issue. Factors considered include whether the issue repeats after coaching, the person's work record and the impact on customers, colleagues and the company.

4. Phase 1: Verbal warning

The immediate manager meets the employee together with the HR Business Partner. They explain the issue or policy breach, the expected standard and the steps needed to improve. The meeting is noted in ZenPeople.

5. Phase 2: Written warning and Performance Improvement Plan

The immediate manager and the department head meet the employee with the HR Business Partner present. The incidents, earlier conversations and consequences of continued failure are documented in a written warning.

A formal Performance Improvement Plan (PIP) is issued within 5 business days of the Phase 2 meeting. A PIP runs for 30 to 60 days with clear goals and weekly check-ins.

6. Phase 3: Suspension and final written warning

Used when temporary removal from work is the most effective action. The immediate manager may suspend an employee with pay pending an investigation when safety or evidence is at risk (up to 15 working days). Suspension as part of normal progression needs approval from the department head and the Head of People & Culture. Suspension without pay needs the CEO's approval and is limited to full-day increments. Pay is restored in full if the investigation clears the employee.

7. Phase 4: Recommendation for termination

The department head may recommend termination. The recommendation needs approval from the Head of People & Culture. For employees in band Z5 and above, the CEO gives the final approval. Termination may happen without earlier phases for serious misconduct.

8. Issues not subject to progressive discipline

The following can lead to immediate suspension or termination, without earlier steps:

- Sexual harassment (investigated by the Internal Committee under ZEN-POL-008).
- Theft, fraud, bribery or falsification of records, credentials or expense claims.
- Violence, threats or fighting at work.
- Working under the influence of alcohol or drugs.
- Intentional breach of data security or deliberate misuse of customer data (ZEN-POL-006).
- Illegal behaviour, which may also be reported to the police.

9. Appeals

The employee may submit information that challenges the facts used in the disciplinary action, or explains extenuating circumstances. This can be done at the meeting or within 5 business days after it, in writing to the Head of People & Culture. The Head of People & Culture reviews with the department head and decides within 10 business days. A final appeal can be made to the CEO.

10. Documentation

The employee receives copies of all discipline documents, including any PIP, and signs to acknowledge receipt and understanding. Copies are kept in the employee's personnel file in ZenPeople.

11. Disclaimer

Zenvora Technologies Pvt. Ltd. reserves the right to change or revise this policy at any time, in any lawful manner, with notice to employees through ZenPeople and Slack #announcements.

Fictional document created for a GraphRAG demonstration project. All people, companies and figures are invented.